Six math clues · answer key

Fingerprints

Age 8 / Grade 2 stretch. Offer tens-and-ones drawings, repeated addition, or oral reasoning.

Math 1 · 73

47 + 26 = 73 ridge marks. Seven ones plus six ones makes 13, so regroup 10 ones as 1 ten.

Math 2 · 39

68 − 29 = 39 cards. Regroup 68 as 5 tens and 18 ones, then subtract.

Math 3 · 94

36 + 58 = 94 sketches. Regroup 14 ones as 1 ten and 4 ones, then add the tens.

Math 4 · 26

72 − 46 = 26 details. Regroup 72 as 6 tens and 12 ones, then subtract.

Math 5 · 83

59 + 24 = 83 cards. Regroup 13 ones as 1 ten and 3 ones, then add the tens.

Math 6 · 44

81 − 37 = 44 cards. Regroup 81 as 7 tens and 11 ones, then subtract.

Grade 2 math. Each problem uses two two-digit numbers and requires regrouping. The quantities belong to the paper story, not to measurements of real fingerprints.

Reading & writing · answer key

Fingerprints

Reading · 1

Raised ridge tops touch the surface and leave lines; lower grooves do not touch, so they leave pale spaces.

Reading · 2

Loop, whorl, and arch describe broad ridge flow. Ridge endings, splits, and other small details add a more specific map.

Reading · 3

The same turns, endings, and splits line up in both impressions even when pressure makes one lighter or smudged.

Writing

Accept a spoken, dictated, drawn, or written comparison that names at least one visible ridge detail.

This pack treats fingerprints as a pattern-and-printmaking study, not as an identity or crime activity. Keep any paper impressions at home; do not photograph, scan, upload, or share them. Use only a non-toxic washable stamp pad, press gently, and wash hands afterward. A fingerprint impression may be incomplete or smudged even though the friction-ridge arrangement beneath it is stable. Loop, whorl, and arch are broad pattern families; trained comparison uses smaller ridge details too.

Welcome speech, dictation, drawing, or writing. One careful comparison with evidence is enough.